How the Uni Era home feed works

What students see, how posts are ranked, how it stays cheap to run, and how it is kept safe. As built on 12 October 2026.

> **In one paragraph.** The home feed is a small social feed for verified university students. Students post text and photos for their own university or for every university, tagged as a question, lost & found, or (for reps, merch leads and staff) a notice. Others like and comment. Each student's feed is ranked for them: recent and active posts first, their own batch higher, posts they have already seen at the bottom. Between posts the feed mixes in kuppi and files from their modules, new shop items and sponsored posts. Three reports hide a post until a moderator decides. A refresh costs one database call, which keeps running costs low.

---

1. What students see

Home is one scrolling list. At the top: the greeting, the ad card, upcoming exams and any unfinished set-up steps. Below that, "Your feed" with a box to write a post, a photo button, and a floating **+ Post** button that is always in reach.

Only approved students see the feed. Students waiting for approval see a note that it opens once they are approved.

A post

- **Who and when:** photo, name, programme and intake year (or their university, when the post comes from elsewhere), and how long ago ("5m", "3h", "2d").
- **Tag (optional):** Question, Lost & found, or Notice. Notices show who they are from, such as "Notice · Batch rep" or a club's name.
- **Text:** up to 1,000 characters. Links open in the browser. Long posts fold after six lines with "See more".
- **Photos:** up to four, laid out before they load so nothing jumps. Tapping one opens it full screen.
- **Like and comment** buttons with counts. Tapping the post opens it with its comments.

Cards mixed in between posts

Card	What it shows	Where
Kuppi coming up	Kuppi in the student's modules in the next 3 days	After the 2nd post
Sponsored	Ads an admin marked "Feed": who it is from, the image, its words and button below	After the 4th, 16th and 28th post
New in the shop	Up to 6 new listings at the student's university, swipeable	After the 7th post
Just shared	Files shared to the student's modules this week	After the 11th post

If a university has few posts, the kuppi, shop and file cards still show at the end, so a new feed is never empty.

2. Posting

- **Who sees it:** "My uni" (default) or "All unis". A post for all universities shows the author's university next to their name.
- **Tags:** anyone can use Question or Lost & found. Only batch reps, merch leads and staff can post a Notice; the server checks this.
- **No anonymous posts and no polls.** Every post carries the author's name. Polls stay in group chats, where people are expected to answer.
- **Photos** are prepared on the phone as two JPEGs with no location data: a 1080 px copy for the feed (about 150 KB) and a full copy of up to 2048 px, loaded only when someone taps the photo.
- **Limits:** 10 posts, 150 comments and 60 photo uploads per student per day.
- A new post appears at the top of the author's own feed straight away.

---

3. How posts are ranked

Each time a student refreshes, the server picks candidates and scores each one for that student.

Candidates

- The newest 400 live posts from the student's university in the last 30 days.
- The newest 100 "All unis" posts from other universities in the last 7 days.
- Removed: posts the student marked "Not interested", posts by people they muted, and anyone blocked in either direction.

Score

```
score = (likes + 3 × comments + 2)^0.8 ÷ (hours since posted + 2)^1.4

× 1.5   same batch as the student
× 1.5   a notice
× 1.2   a question nobody has answered yet
× 0.8   from another university
× 0.5   a tag the student hid at least twice in the last 30 days
× 0.15  already seen by the student (sinks to the bottom, still there)
× 0.6 per extra post from the same author (2nd × 0.6, 3rd × 0.36 …)

The student's own post from the last hour always goes first.
```

In plain words: engagement lifts a post, age pulls it down, and comments count three times as much as likes because they show a real conversation. The extra factors favour what matters most to a student (their batch, questions that need an answer, official notices) and stop one person filling the feed.

Never the same post twice

- **Within a session:** the ranked order (up to 200 posts) is fixed when the feed refreshes, and the app loads the posts in that order 15 at a time, so scores changing while scrolling cannot repeat or skip a post.
- **Across sessions:** a post counts as seen once half of it has been on screen for a second. Seen posts score × 0.15, so they sink below anything new. Seen records are kept for 10 days.

4. Likes, comments and the post menu

Likes

The heart fills at once. The app waits 400 ms before telling the server, so several quick taps send one request. Liking twice counts once.

Comments

Oldest first, with one level of replies under each comment. A reply to a reply goes under the same comment. The comment box stays above the keyboard and says who you are replying to.

Post menu

- **Not interested:** the post is replaced by a one-line note with Undo. The second time for the same author, the note offers Mute.
- **Mute:** their posts leave your feed. They are not told.
- **Report:** with a reason; optionally block them too.
- **Delete:** your own posts, with their photos and comments.

5. Notifications

Event	Who hears it
A comment on your post	The author, at most once every 15 minutes per post
A reply to your comment	The comment's author, at most once every 15 minutes
Likes	The author, grouped ("Nimal and 4 others liked your post"), at most once an hour per post
Your post was hidden or removed	The author

New posts never notify anyone, so nobody can buzz a whole university. On Android these use their own channel, "Posts and comments", which students can turn off separately. Quiet hours apply, and tapping a notification opens the post.

6. Moderation and safety

- **Reports:** when three different students report a post, it is hidden from everyone but its author until a moderator looks. The author is told. Three reports on a comment remove it; the report keeps a copy as evidence.
- **Moderators** (staff of that university) open Profile → Reported posts, see each post with the reasons given, and choose Restore or Remove. They can also remove any post or comment directly. Every decision is recorded in the audit log.
- **Blocks** work both ways: neither person sees the other's posts or comments.
- **Server-side rules:** all reading and writing goes through checked database functions. Students cannot read or change the tables directly.
- **Photos** can only be attached after the server checks that both copies really are JPEGs of the sizes reserved. They are stored under random names in the public bucket: fast and free to serve, but anyone who has a photo's exact address can open it, as with Instagram or Facebook.

7. Ads in the feed

In the admin ad manager (Profile → Ads), each ad has **Shows on: Home card, Feed, or both**. In the feed an ad looks like a post card: "Sponsored · sponsor" on top, the 1200 × 628 image uncovered, then the headline, text and button below. Ads never come first and appear at most once in every 12 posts. The admin list shows viewers and taps separately for the Home card and the feed, counted once per student per day.

8. Why it is cheap to run

Pull to refresh 1 database call returns the ranked order, the first 15 posts and every mixed-in card	→ **Scroll** 1 call per 15 posts; posts seen since the last call ride along in it	→ **Like** 1 small call after taps settle; counts are stored on the post, never recounted	→ **Post with photos** 2 edge-function calls for all photos, then 1 database call

- **No live connections** for the feed. It refreshes when pulled, on opening Home, or after 15 minutes away.
- **Only what the screen needs:** about 1 KB per post. Comments load only when a post is opened, 50 threads at a time.
- **Photos** come from Cloudflare R2, which charges nothing to serve them, and are cached on the phone. The small feed copy keeps students' mobile data low.
- **Instant open:** the last feed is kept on the phone and shown at once, then refreshed quietly.
- **Smooth scrolling:** the list (FlashList) draws only what is on screen and reuses cards as you scroll.

Rough scale: a student who opens the feed three times a day makes about 20 small database calls. At 5,000 daily students that is roughly 100,000 calls a day, well within the Supabase Pro plan.

9. Not built yet

- **Boarding places (bodim)** as structured listings with area, rent, who it is for, distance to campus, facilities and student reviews, shown in the feed and in their own section.
- **Events** such as hackathons, once the Events tab is built.
- **Clean-up of leftover photos** from posts that were never finished or from deleted accounts.
- **Editing a post** (today: delete and post again).